

Guide for Grown-Ups

Going through grief can be hard, especially when your child is going through it, too. Here is some advice on how to manage the situation with your little one:

What should I tell my child?

- Try to be as honest and open as possible about what has happened.
- Use simple, age-appropriate language to explain everything, and break it down so that it is easier for your child to understand.
- Listen to your child. It's okay if you don't have all of the answers right now, but it is important that they feel supported and heard by you.
- Make sure that they know that they can talk to you, or others if they would prefer, at any time.

What else can I do to help them?

- Seek professional support if you are worried about your child.
- Remember, it is ok to cry and show your emotions in front of them. This shows them that you are grieving too, and encourages them to share their emotions with you.
- Children like routine, so try to keep things as normal as possible. But make sure that you also have some fun together.
- Talk about the person who has died. It can be nice to share memories with each other, and commemorate birthdays and other significant dates.

Resources:

- The Dougy Center - An organization that provides support to both adults and children who are experiencing grief.
- Actively Moving Forward - An app that provides teens with a network where they can feel connected and understood by young people who are going through a similar loss. It offers support groups, videos, comment boards, and allows its members to chat with each other.
- Family Lives On - An organization for children whose mother or father have died, which understands the importance of continuing family traditions that were celebrated with their deceased parent.
- The National Alliance for Grieving Children (NAGC) - a nonprofit organization that raises awareness about children and teens who are grieving the loss of someone close to them. It also provides education and resources for parents and other caregivers.

